The Pet Vet *The leading journal for the pet vet industry*

Strategies to help your organisation survive in an increasingly competitive market

By Theo Dupont, Business Editor, April 20X4

Investing in technology or demonstrating corporate social responsibility are two strategies which can provide competitive advantage.

Technology

There are three areas in which technology is impacting our industry.

1. **Impact on vet medicine.** Smart collars and harnesses worn by pets capture vital statistics, such as heart rate, and so help keep track of a pet's health on a continuous basis. These devices can also help to improve diagnoses and result in better, quicker and more accurate treatment. New technology also facilitates simpler surgery which significantly reduces recovery time for pets and improves outcomes. 3D printing can create perfectly tailored, custom bones and prosthetics for pets. AI-powered technology can 'learn' what is normal and abnormal and can be used to analyse laboratory results significantly more quickly and at least as accurately as humans.

2. **Impact on communication with clients.** Cloud-based integrated business management software offers online booking for clients and sends follow-ups and reminders. Telehealth, often via smartphones, enables veterinarians to provide – from any location – virtual consultations. Clients can upload photos or videos of their pets which allow veterinarians to make straightforward diagnoses and recommend appropriate treatment or propose a face-to-face consultation. Digital marketing can improve levels of client attraction, engagement and loyalty.

3. **Impact on clinic management.** Newer business management software also schedules consultations, shows patient records, and captures and stores diagnostic images. It allows veterinarians to access and analyse data (on-site and off-site) and gives them direct access to test results from laboratories. It can also order and track retail and medicine inventory, invoice clients, and measure and monitor clinic efficiency and profit.

Corporate social responsibility (CSR)

There is growing public interest on how businesses treat their staff, how they interact with society and their environmental impact. Recent research shows that 70% of consumers in Arland want to know the brands they are supporting address social and environmental issues. According to the same research, employees look for and are more engaged and perform better for socially-responsible businesses: implementing CSR can cut staff turnover by 35% and increase productivity by 13%.

Whilst there are costs associated with CSR, and consumers are becoming more aware of 'greenwashing', CSR has been shown to create significant value and benefit the bottom line.